

Plural Perspectives on Economics & Ecology



Cartoon: Sophie Bédard Script: Neil Lancaster

Daniel Macmillen Voskoboynik

Scenario

BREAKING NEWS - Malmo City Council has just announced an executive decision. In a surprise decision, the Council has tasked the HEK class to select a team of expert advisors to decide on the city's ecological-economic strategy until 2030. Which 7 people - based on their profession or background or disciplinary expertise or any other criteria - are you inviting?

Plurality & Economics

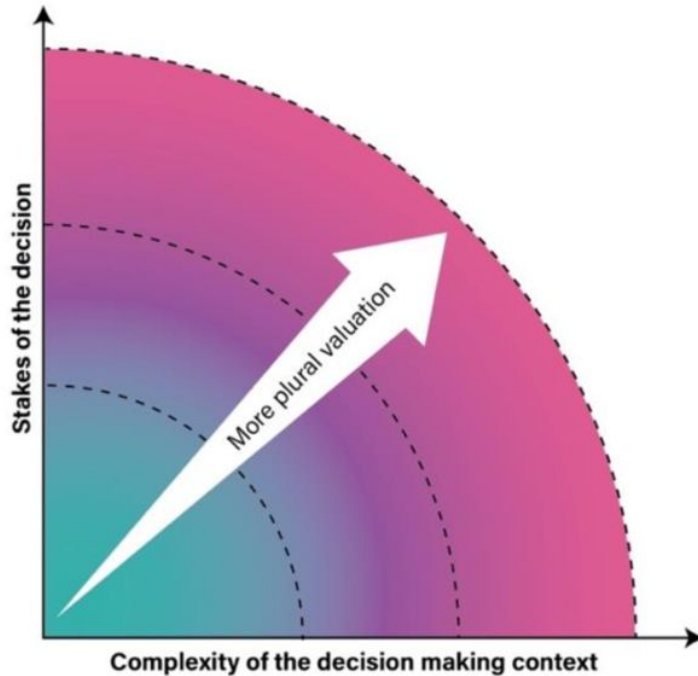
- Emerging from embeddedness (Polanyi)
- From methodological pluralism to value pluralism to ideological pluralism
- Only around 5% of articles published in the 5 most prestigious economics journals come from outside the United States (Ek and Henrekson, 2019).

High stakes

- Hard to reverse
- High impact on stakeholders
- Competing interests between stakeholders

Low stakes

- Easy to reverse
- Low impact on stakeholders
- Stakeholder interests are aligned



Low complexity

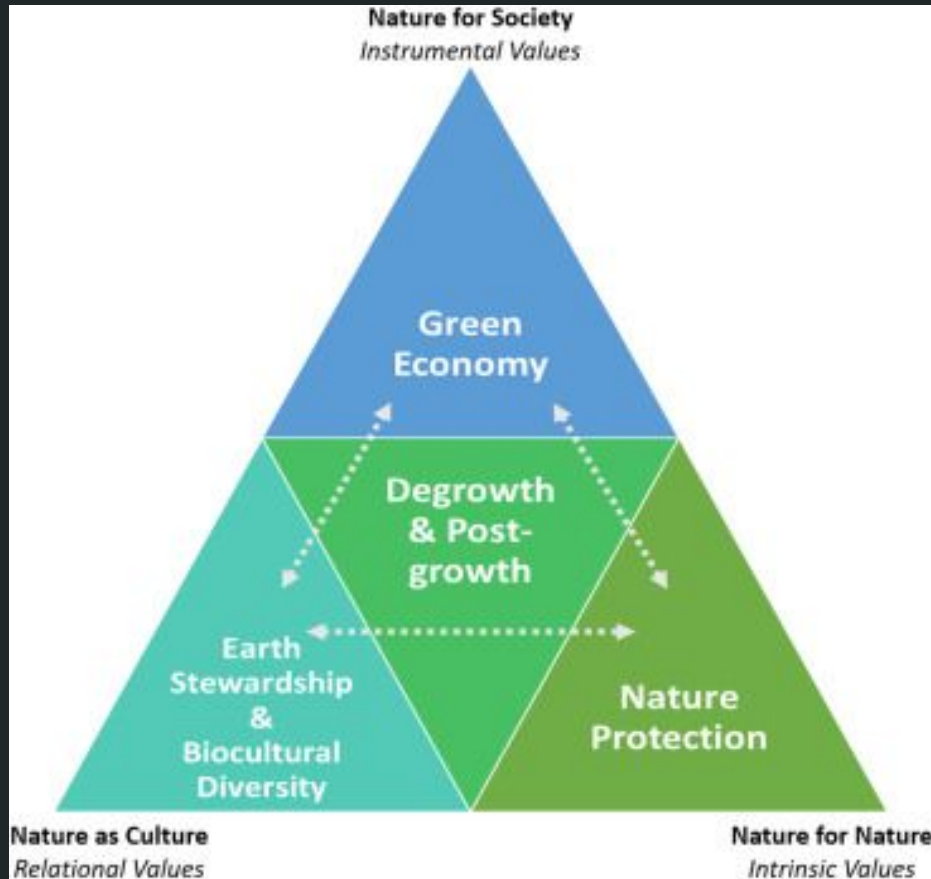
- Simple social-ecological context
- Low diversity of stakeholders
- Low diversity of values
- Low uncertainty

High complexity

- Complex social-ecological context
- High diversity of stakeholders
- High diversity of values
- High uncertainty

Source: Balvanera et al. 2022.

Plurality of Values



Source: (Martin et al. 2024)

Plurality & Economics

**What does a
pluralist
economics
education look
like?**



**Promoting Economic
Pluralism**



1
Diverse

Teach diverse perspectives from
economics and other disciplines



2
Ecologically
Conscious

Recognise the economy is entirely
dependent on the natural world



3
Real-world

Use real-world evidence and help
students assess its credibility



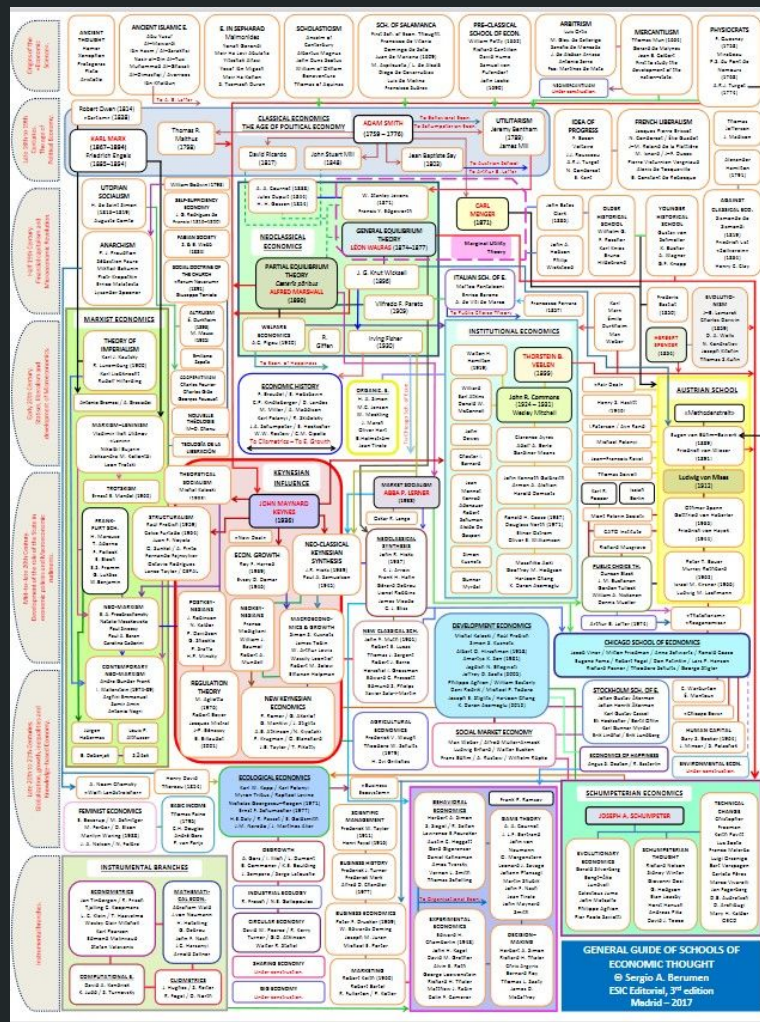
4
Reflective

Involve students in examining the
historical context, assumptions and
values in all economic thinking



5
Continual
Improvement

Keep improving teaching culture and
capacity



(See Berumen 2021;
 Dobusch, L., and J. Kapeller. 2012)

Schools of Economics

At least 9 major schools

Classical

Neoclassical

Marxist

Keynesian

Schumpeterian (neo-Schumpeterian)

Austrian

Institutionalist (Old and New)

Behavioural

Developmental

Several smaller schools

Neo-Ricardian

Latin American Structuralist

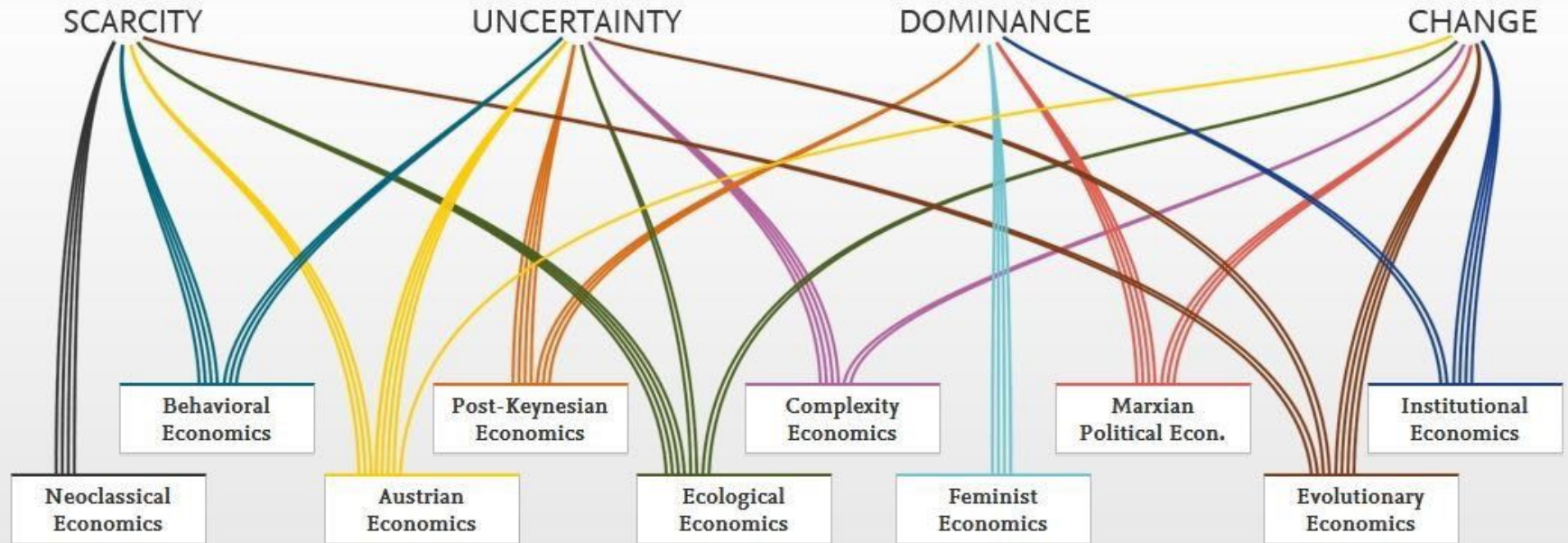
Evolutionary

Feminist

Ecological

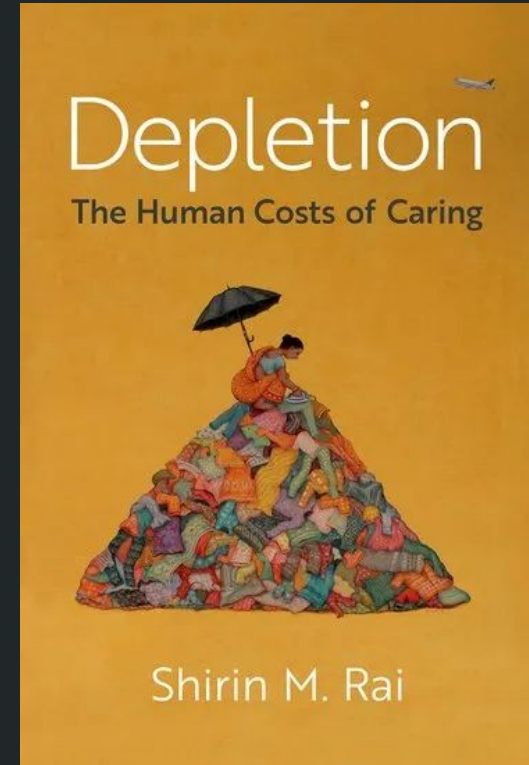
Source: Institute for New Economic Thinking

▼ Which problem is central to the economy?



A range of emphases

- *Institutional Economics*: focus on formal institutions such as laws and political structure, and informal institutions like norms, habits, and values.
- *Evolutionary economics*: Path dependency
- *Marxist economics*: strong examination of ownership, class relations
- *Feminist economics*: clear focus on inequality, care, invisibilised labour, gender inequities





Solidarity economics

Source: Grassroots Economic Organising

Solidarity economics

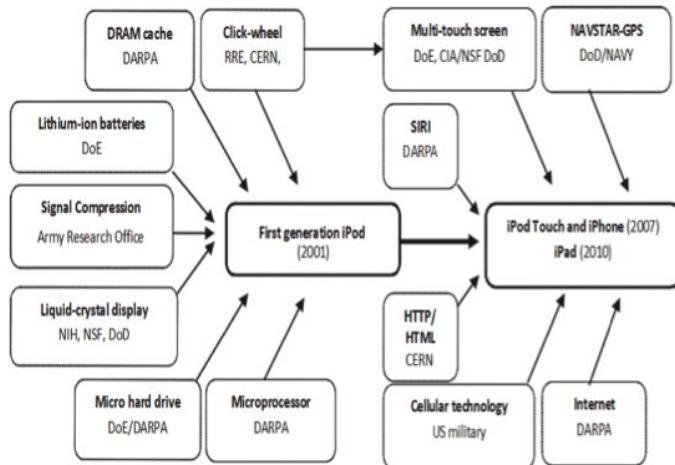


Source: Sustainability Action Fund

- Turning our gaze to the institutional, social and relational configurations that activate the innovations we need in society

Innovation Economics

What makes the iPhone so 'smart'?



MARIANA MAZZUCATO

**THE
ENTREPRENEURIAL
STATE**

'BRILLIANT'
MARTIN WOLF, FINANCIAL TIMES

**DEBUNKING
PUBLIC**

**VS
PRIVATE
SECTOR
MYTHS**



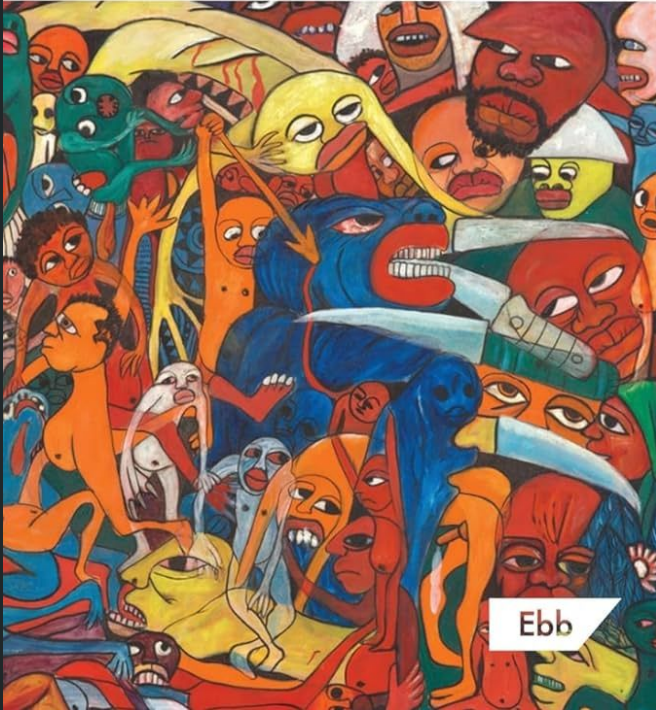
10TH ANNIVERSARY
EDITION, UPDATED
WITH A NEW PREFACE



EDITED BY LEO ZEILIG, CHINEDU
CHUKWUDINMA, AND BEN RADLEY

Voices for African Liberation

Conversations with the Review of African
Political Economy

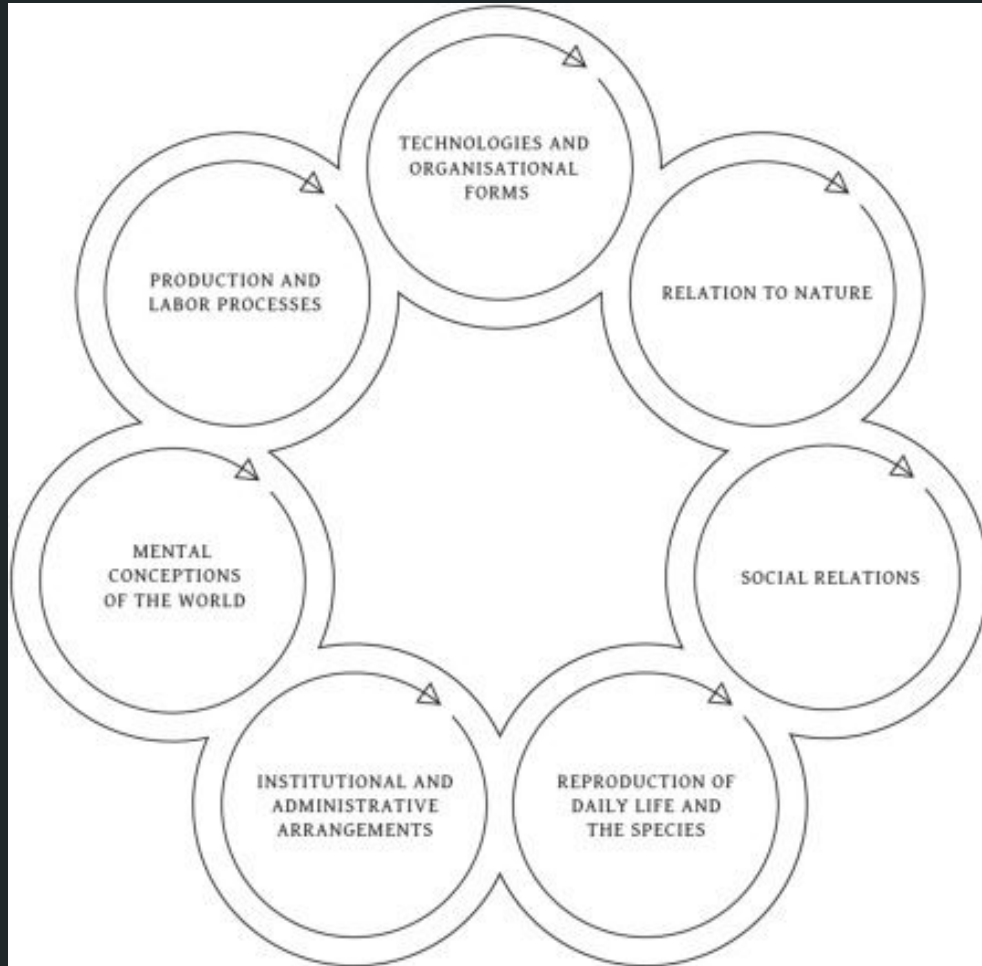


Decolonial economics

We believe that in order to build a solidarity economy, we need to first understand the depth to which colonialism has influenced our modern economic system through the extraction of power and resources from marginalised communities and the accumulation of wealth and power in whiteness, middle-classness and cis-straightness).

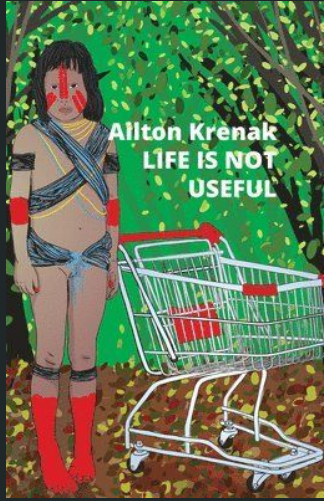
Source: Decolonising Economics

Anthropocene Economics



Source: Boehnert 2018

Reforesting our economic-ecological imaginations



“Life is so wonderful that our minds try to make it useful, but that's nonsense. Life is enjoyment, it's a dance, only it's a cosmic dance, and we want to reduce it to a ridiculous, utilitarian choreography.”

“White people's empty thinking can't live with the idea of living in the world for nothing, they think that work is the reason for existence.”

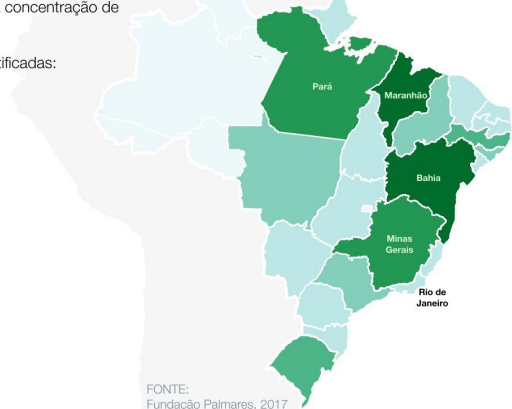
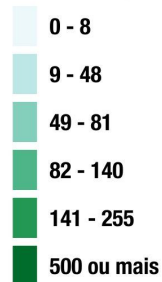


ancestral futurism
vs technological productivism

Comunidades quilombolas

Cerca de 2,6 mil quilombos estão certificados pela Fundação Palmares. Confira a concentração de comunidades por estado.

Número de comunidades certificadas:



FONTE:
Fundação Palmares, 2017

mapa por auit studio • findauit.com

Quilombola thinking



Afro-Pindoramic thought



Antonio Bispo dos Santos
quilombola philosophy

- Confronting **cosmophobia**: terror around the diversity of life, and plurality of worlds
- Development or **envelopment**
- Competition or **confluence**
- Isolation or **transfluence**
- **Ecological affection & reciprocity**: “the earth gives, the earth wants/asks.”

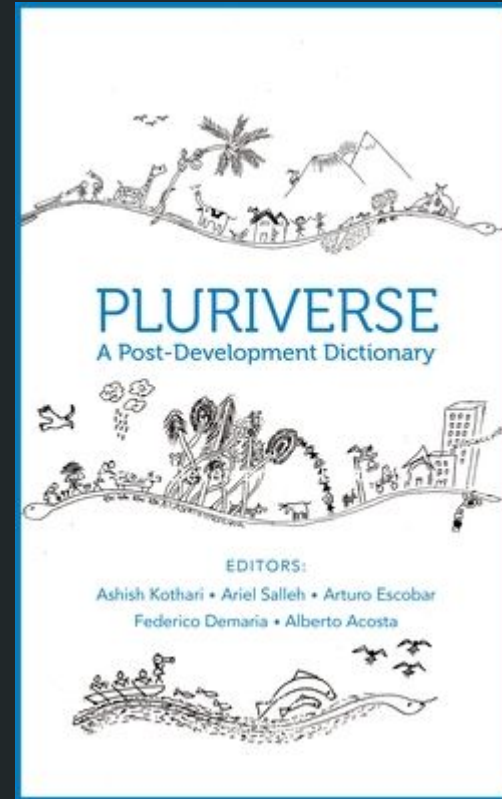
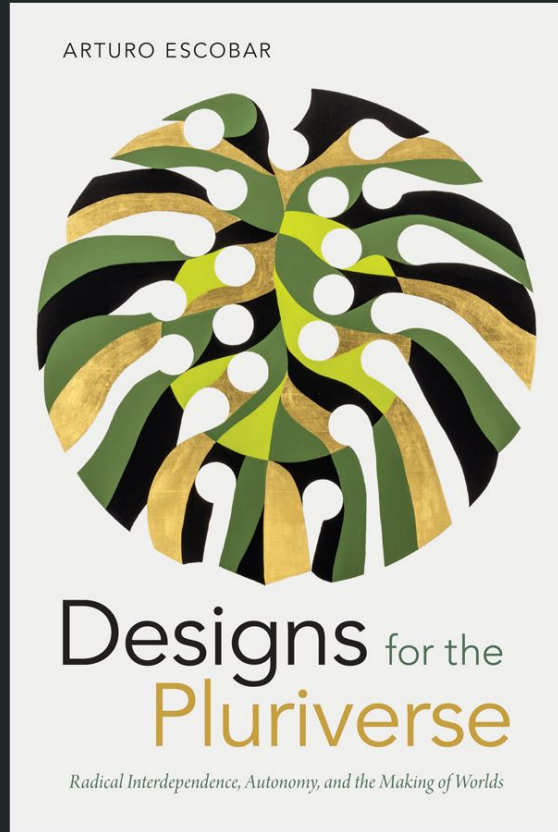
“We see things in a circular way; we think and act in a circular way, and for us there is no ending—we can always find a way to start over.

Our way of thinking allows us to better scale things, movements, and spaces. Circular spaces can fit more than rectangular ones. This enables us to live well with diversity and always think that the Other is important. We understand the need for other people to exist.”

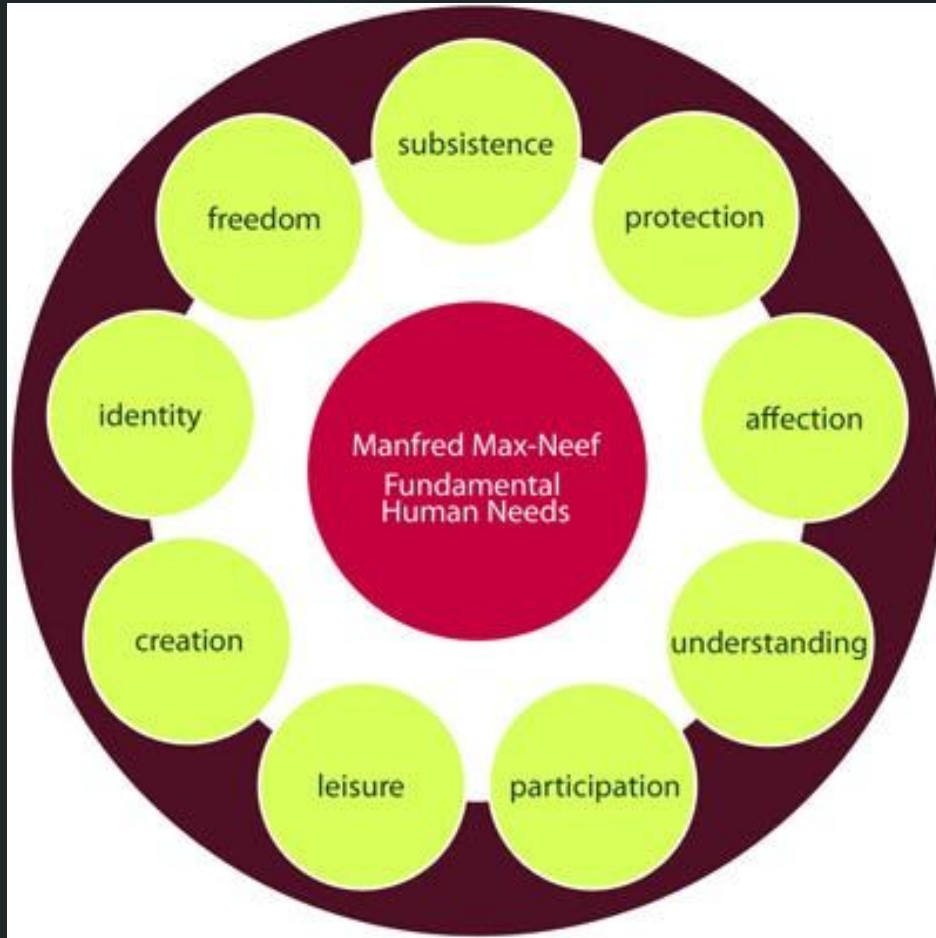
Reforesting our economic-ecological imaginations

“We are debating **counter-colonization**. For us, quilombolas and Indigenous peoples, this is the agenda: counter-colonization. The day universities learn what they do not know, the day universities agree to learn Indigenous languages—instead of teaching them, the day universities agree to learn Indigenous architecture and to learn about the plants of the caatinga, the day they are willing to learn from us as we once learned from them, then we will have a confluence. A confluence of knowledge. A process of balancing the different civilizations of this place. Counter-colonization.” - Antonio Bispo dos Santos

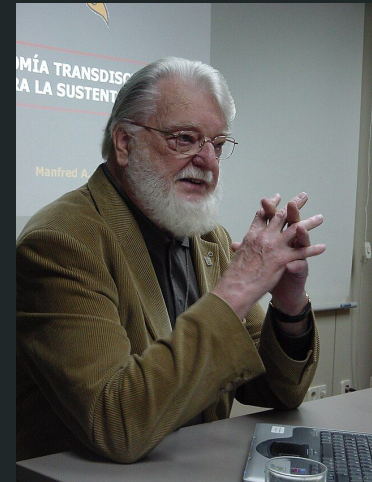
Pluriverse - a world where many worlds fit



Manfred Max-Neef



- Development at a human scale
- Economic knowledge vs. understanding
- Barefoot economics - to get into the mud



An Invitation - A Day Meditation on Barefoot Economics

Take one full day to be a barefoot ecological economist. Immerse yourself in observing all the ecological-economic interactions in your day. Take note of all economic interactions and origins, from the water flowing from your tap, to the production supply chain of each snack you consume , to the infrastructure you step on throughout the city. Perhaps you can notice the labours of care you receive and participate in. Take some time to reflect on this experience, and changes in your attention through the day.

Further Resources

- Oikos International
- Decolonising Economics
- Diversifying & Decolonising Economics Network
- Institute for New Economic Thinking
- Rethinking Economics
- Doughnut Economics